



DRAFT 385  
風  
SUMMER 2024



# FOREWORD

June 6, 2024, Dialogue House, ICU

With finals week wriggling its way into our minds, Room 203 became a bustling haven for 11 student translators who sought refuge from lectures. Although what awaited us was yet another lecture... This, however, was not your ordinary talk-and-chalk session; no, this was an *Experience* asking us to confront our *inner serial killer*, examine the connections between translation and Japanese toilets, and last but not least, stare intently into origami paper.

Let me explain.

On June 6, Dr. James Garza hosted a special event entitled “Translation and Creative Writing: A Workshop with Special Guest Hiromitsu Koiso.” The workshop got off to an exciting start with an introduction by Dr. Garza about the connection between reading and rewriting, specifically the rewriting we do in our minds as readers, and how closely this is related to translation. Take a look at the following two-panel comic.



(McCloud, 1993/2020, p. 74)

Do any of the panels show the man being slaughtered?

> No.

But did you assume he was slaughtered?

> Yes.

*You serial killer! You monster!*

## Draft 385とは？

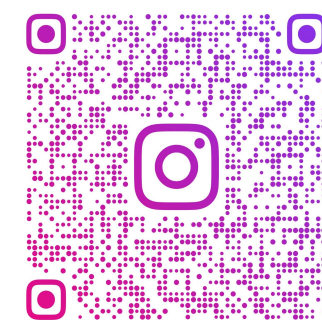
*Draft 385* は2023年冬学期に開講された「MCC385 翻訳特別研究」の受講生らが発案し、創刊したマガジンです。その後、独立した学生団体へと展開し、文学を始めとしたアートに取り組むICUの学生が自身の創作物を共有できる場所となっています。

本誌の出発点は翻訳セミナーであるため、言語と翻訳を軸に幅広い芸術作品を扱うことが基本理念です。「ほぼバイリンガル」というコンセプトのもと日英の散文や韻文、翻訳、アートなどといった幅広い分野の紹介を目指しています。

人それぞれの言語能力や、それに影響した境遇がどのようなものであろうと、言語に関する知識は経験や捉え方に応じて常に変化していくものです。それを踏まえると、翻訳の対象となる二言語やICUで飛び交っている(主な)二言語について、いずれも「二言語」が二項対立的な関係にあると見なしているようでは、入り組んだ言語的・文化的アイデンティティを十分に理解しきることは難しいでしょう。そのため本誌は、学内で飛び交う(日英をはじめとした)多様な言語が交差し、絡み合う機会を作ることが目標です。文学やアートを通して言語間の「区切り」を再考し、言語と文化の新たな土俵を築いていきたいと考えています。

発行頻度は春学期末と冬学期末の年二回です。春号ではICUの学生を中心とした公募を、冬号ではMCC385の受講生による作品を主に掲載します。

作品紹介やワークショップの告知などはInstagram([@icu\\_draft385](https://www.instagram.com/icu_draft385))で発信中です。質問や意見、アイデアなどのお問い合わせは[icu\\_draft385@gmail.com](mailto:icu_draft385@gmail.com)までご連絡ください。



ICU\_DRAFT385

## About *Draft 385*

*Draft 385* began as a zine produced by the members of the Winter 2023 MCC385 “Advanced Studies in Translation” class at ICU. We have since branched off into an independent student organization on campus that works to support ICU students in the pursuit of both literary and non-literary artistic work.

The first issue of *Draft 385* was born in a translation seminar, and as such, our roots will always be in language and translation, but we welcome submissions of creative work in all forms. We have conceptualized the zine as a “roughly bilingual” zine of English and Japanese works that include poetry, prose, art, translation, and other (possibly multimedia) works.

Whether we are monolingual or multilingual—whether we are native speakers, heritage speakers, or second-language learners of a particular language—our knowledge of language is dynamic, constantly changing in response to our experiences and perceptions. The assumption of two entirely distinct sides, in translation or in the “bilingualism” of the ICU campus, is no longer adequate to describe the complexities of our linguistic and cultural identities. *Draft 385* aims to be a space where the variety of languages on our “bilingual”—but really *multilingual*—campus can meet and intertwine, a place where we allow literature and art to explore and redefine those boundaries, carving our own landscapes of language and culture.

*Draft 385* will be published twice a year, once at the end of ICU’s winter term, and once at the end of the spring term. The spring issue features open submissions from members of ICU and beyond, while the winter issue focuses on (but is not limited to) work produced by students of MCC385.

Follow us on Instagram [@icu\\_draft385](https://www.instagram.com/icu_draft385) to see what we’re up to, get a sense of the types of work we publish, and stay tuned to any events (talks, workshops, readings, and more)! Additionally, if you have any questions, feedback, or ideas for a future edition, feel free to email us at [icu.draft385@gmail.com](mailto:icu.draft385@gmail.com).



Submission Guidelines  
投稿規定

We described the preceding scene to each other in words – an act of intersemiotic translation, to be precise, and reached the following general consensus: an ojisan flings an axe and murders a man. The takeaway here is: all translations involve some form of interpretation, of putting ourselves into the text as active readers and re-writing it in our minds, resulting in a new text (Pope 41-44). There seems to be no way around it. No translation without interpretation. This process underlies the idea of Prismatic Translation, where because “translation generates multiple new texts...it is inherently creative” (Matthew et al. 131).

The mini-lecture was followed by a poetry reading from poet and literary translator Hiromitsu Koiso, who has translated works by prominent writers such as Anne Carson, Teju Cole, Grayson Perry, and Ocean Vuong. The following are the first two lines of his bilingual poem “Interview with a Japanese Toilet”:

モットーはありますか  
Q tell me your own motto

基 本 的 人 権 の 尊 重  
A for some situations, one step forward, you know

Here, we have an example where creative writing meets translation. The Japanese translation (ruby) does not always match up with the English text but rather becomes a new element in the poem, resulting in a gain in meaning. Koiso-san gave us an inside glimpse into the unique process that led him to produce this piece, revealing that he wrote the Japanese ruby “as they came to mind” when revisiting the English poem he had written years earlier.

Channeling his spontaneous creativity, we attempted a similar activity. The rules were simple. Randomly pick a sheet of colored origami paper. Stare at it. Then, release your inner dialogue in written form. All in the span of three minutes. This is what we came up with:

green is ravenous, nutritious  
is the crunch of a healthy  
thought (しりもちの  
おきりのごほうび)

indigo: ocean blue,  
sea salt settling on summertime lips.  
Grains of sand, gritty, beneath my feet  
as sea spray settles on my skin.

lavender: dreamy, relaxed  
eyelids getting heavy after a long day.  
The sun sinks to slumber  
and dyes the sky in muted tones.

yellow is 太陽を浴びている 目眩  
the edge of an abyss in summer

lime green: grass, trees, forest  
the sight of summer Bakayama,  
the low hum of cicadas crowds the air  
as the humid day shines with lush life.

gray is what purple wants to  
be but it lacks conviction  
is the message of a lead  
angel  
(んた) ちきり  
がんばた いぬへのごほうび



blue is deep confusion  
 A Hockney pool ~~about to~~  
 with ~~who knows what~~  
 more blue at the bottom

green leaves me stranded in a lush, lonely thought  
 おどろはしはくのおくこのせうほう

bubblegum pink: artificial, saccharine sweet,  
 天竺の味く  
 but no less delicious than the natural flavors of nature.  
 the color of candy pop, sugar scented candyland.

My heart is the Atlantic  
 You're blinding me like an ocean beyond clear windows  
 Bright, not like the darkness of the Atlantic  
 There's a clock behind us, I can hear it tick  
 I wish on every breath, this blue does not throw  
 our memories down the road

warm pleasant feeling  
 the yellow of a man on a ladder  
 sunny yellow  
 before falling  
 yellow  
 きいろはたいようをまびらきぬま

As we took turns reading our work aloud, we couldn't help but nod vigorously at every word uttered, unable to wrap our heads around the extent of each other's abilities. However, many of us were unsatisfied with what we had produced, inching our way towards the door in the hopes of making a heroic escape before the inevitable fate of reading our poetry aloud enveloped us. In case you (the reader) feel the same, or are hesitant to make whatever idea you have had in mind for a while a reality, here is something to keep in mind...

Sometimes—well, most of the time—the thing you created turns out to be an abomination, and you end up surprising even yourself with how incapable you were. You shove that creation away in the compartment of your brain inaccessible to anyone but yourself, and slam it shut (only to stumble upon it several years down the line...). But other times, everything *clicks*; you are satisfied with your creation, and it feels like an extension of your identity. Regardless, the trivial act of creating “the thing” — no matter the quality — invokes a lifelong attraction, triggering an itch that can only be scratched through repeatedly engaging in the creative process. We hope that the following issue on *Color* inspires you to engage in the gradual process of art.

Rintaro Kimura

#### Works Cited

- McCloud, Scott. *Understanding Comics: The Invisible Art*. Translated by Shiina Yukari, Tokyo: Fukkan Dotto Komu, 2020.
- Pope, Rob. “Critical Creative Re-Writing: A Briefing.” *European Messenger*, no.2, 1999.
- Reynolds, Matthew, et al. “Prismatic translation.” *Creative Multilingualism*, edited by Kohl et al. Open Book Publishers, 2020, pp. 131–50.

#### Contributors | 投稿者

- > Kai Schmiedel is a sophomore studying at ICU. Christian, American, escapist, and a sloth at heart, he hopes to combine these aspects with what he sees in the world and create wonderful things. He has also dabbled in debate, theater, choir, writing, poetry, running— whatever the theme of the month would be. His work currently can be found on social media accounts such as X under the pen name “rorobiolum.”
- > Kyle Lin studied at ICU as an exchange student during the September 2023-24 school year. He is now a senior majoring in Computer Science at the University of California, Riverside. He enjoys many forms of art, such as programming language design, game development, drawing, writing, and music composition. His other hobbies include listening to podcasts, reading, and going on walks. Many of his works can be found the neighboring QR code:
- > Tomas Cordero is a senior majoring in English at UC Santa Barbara. Born and raised in California, he studied at ICU as a One-Year Regular from Autumn 2023 to Spring 2024. Though he takes an interest in all things creative, poetry represents his longest and most sustained artistic venture. He fell in love with the genre through the works of Shel Silverstein and Bill Watterson, and he hopes to share this same inspiration with students in his future career as a schoolteacher. His other hobbies include songwriting, drawing, and language learning. The poem “The Red Beret” marks his first publication.
- > Tony Hao is a Connecticut-based literary translator from Mandarin to English. His works have appeared in The Common, MAYDAY Magazine, Crayon (sister magazine of Litro), and elsewhere.





# WHAT COLOR MEANS TO OUR ZINE

## Student Staff | 学生スタッフ

- > J. Charles Stephens is an OYR at ICU from Rutgers University, there engaging with Japanese Poetic Translation and Documentary Poetry. Other activities include calligraphy, floral design, and work with FENCE Books. Personal activities consist primarily of translations of indie Japanese electronic music.
- > Maiya Intan is a junior who is majoring in Literature and minoring in American Studies. Her consciousness was formed on the islands of Indonesia and is currently planted within the vast networks of Tokyo. A lover of music (from Laufey to Childish Gambino), she happens to write poetry and fiction from time to time. She would also like to point out that she loves books (from Sci-Fi to Existential Crisis on Paper). Her works can be found in ICU's newspaper, *The Weekly Giants*, under a pseudonym that shall never be named.
- > Pinyu Hwang is an OYR at ICU and a recent graduate from Yale University with a double major in Computer Science and Linguistics. She moved from Taiwan to the U.S. with her family in middle school. She is fascinated by the ways language becomes art, visually and linguistically, through its shapes and its meanings. She is fond of food, crafts, stories, sleep, and language. Her translations of (mostly) contemporary Taiwanese poetry can be found in *Exchanges*, *Asymptote blog*, *MAYDAY*, *ctrl + v journal*, and, yes, *Draft 385*. (Instagram: @pearlh6527)
- > Rintaro Kimura/木村凜太郎 is a sophomore at ICU, with interests in American literature and translation. Despite spending the majority of his childhood in Hsinchu, Taiwan (11 years!), he feels most connected to Miasa, Nagano, where living in a cottage in the woods sprouted his appreciation for nature. He is drawn to surrealism and takes great pleasure in evoking reactions that often border on confusion. Long time cat lover.
- > Erika Morita





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About *Draft 385*/Draft 385とは？

### Faculty Advisor | 顧問教員

- > James Garza is an Assistant Professor of Translation Studies at ICU. His work has appeared in *Asymptote*, *Modern Poetry in Translation* and *Poetry*, among other places. His translation of Itō Shizuo's 'Going Home' won the 2019 Stephen Spender Prize for poetry in translation. James is currently co-translating the English edition of Dazai Osamu's first published collection of short stories, *The Final Years*.

### Student Staff | 学生スタッフ

- > Alyssa Kimura/木村アリサ is a junior majoring in Media, Communication, and Culture at ICU. She was born and raised in Hawaii and aspires to become a translator in the future. An avid artist and creative writer, she often takes inspiration from the natural world and the legends of various cultures. She loves wordplay, particularly terrible puns, and typically includes comic elements in her writing. Her other hobbies include drawing, video games, musical theatre, and magic. Examples of her work can be found in *Mane O Ke Ola* and *Draft 385*.
- > Aeris Golden-Thompson is an aspiring translator and junior in the Media, Communication, and Culture major at ICU. Crossing the globe from Washington DC, they now live in Japan where they dabble in a variety of creative pursuits such as art, fashion, tarot, TTRPGs, writing, and traditional Japanese dance (*nihon buyo*). They enjoy reading and creating sapphic works, all of which you can view on their Twitter/Instagram/Tumblr: @aerlili. They have been published in the following: *Japan In DC* and our very own *Draft 385*.
- > Anika Suwakumar likes to engage herself with activities involving introspection and exploration of expression. She loves reading literature and finds herself drawn towards the way authors express their ideas through their well crafted words. She enjoys spending time rather idly, entertaining herself with activities such as drawing, writing, and watching films. She also enjoys outdoor activities such as cloud watching and people watching. You might find her walking, biking or taking photos around occasionally.
- > Ayaka Kondo/近藤彩夏 is a senior majoring in Media, Communications and Culture at ICU. Spending their formative years in Ohio, many of their works focus on their bicultural experience. An aspiring scriptwriter, their plays “442: an original play about the experiences of American persons of Japanese ancestry” and “Shakespeare’s Sister” have been performed at ICU’s theatre club Gekidan Kokasha. They enjoy reading, pigeon-watching and theater-going.



Slaves in This World of Dust

all of yesterday's promises      will be tomorrow's dazzling  
all those moving stories      worshipped as legends that never  
all the poor and the rich      all uprooted from their  
all their endless sorrows      rewritten as flowery snowy  
We are all slaves in      This world of dust  
All we need is some      Bread and love  
We are all slaves in      This world of dust  
We live and don't know      When death will come

The original lyrics:

尘世奴隶

**Verse** (Each verse line occupies four bars. One bolded phrase occupies one bar (7 beats); one underlined phrase occupies one bar; one italicized word occupies one bar; and then there's a bar of only instrumental music after)

都是从前的誓言， 都是明天灿烂的谎言  
都是动人的故事， 都是人间不朽的传奇  
都是穷人和富人， 都是没有了家园的人  
都是永世的遗憾， 都是风花雪月的诗篇

**Chorus** (Each chorus line occupies two bars. One bolded phrase occupies one bar (7 beats); one underlined phrase occupies one bar; Note that the highlighted words are split in two bars)

我们都是尘世的奴隶，  
我们只要粮食和爱情  
我们都是尘世的奴隶，  
我们活着等待着死去

## THE COLOR CODE ・ カラーコード



Art ・ アート



Prose ・ 散文



Poetry ・ 韻文



Multimedia ・ マルチメディア



Translation ・ 翻訳



Front/Back Matter  
まえがき / あとがき





Pinyu Hwang

#FFD000  
Egg yolk. Construction site. Dandelions are weeds—are they? Yard work.  
marigold  
The coin flower in Plants vs. Zombies. The sunflower. Corn.  
Blocks of butter.

#D2A6FF  
Crabtree & Evelyn. I think that’s what it was. I don’t really like  
lavender-scented hand cream. (Or anything else. Including tea.  
Or chamomile tea, but that is a different color.) Hand cream reminds me of  
airports. Tax-free shops. You don’t pay taxes because you don’t  
belong anywhere. Unless you’re American, then  
you pay taxes everywhere.

春聯 • 紅 包 • #AF072C ~ #460B05  
New Year. Wedding. It’s not dark enough to be menstruation. Or just  
blood, from anywhere. Too festive. Scissors.

And when the music moves to the chorus section, I hear four beats first (4/4) and feel that the speaker is finally ready to tell what he wasn’t able to tell in the verse section – but then the second half of each bar only has three beats (3/4). In other words, I hear the speaker/singer rushing to conclude his thoughts before he finishes everything he has in mind. He doesn’t give himself enough time to rest and breathe before hurrying to the next verse.

I thus hear a storied yet somewhat mercurial speaker. He wants to sing about his experience being a slave of the dusty, humble human world, yet he struggles to find a confident, stable, consistent rhythm to tell his story. He shifts between as if delivering a eulogy and as if hastily wrapping up a confession. He wavers between wanting to say a little more and refraining from saying the right amount. I want my translation to show the music’s offbeat, incomplete-sounding, and wobbly rhythm. I want to capture the singer’s uncertainty about whether to withhold his last beat or offer an additional beat.

Third, the eight ‘all’s (都是 dou shi) in the structure. In Chinese, every line in the verse reads according to the syllogistic structure “all are X, all are Y.” The X and the Y are juxtaposed in the same line, but they’re nothing but equivalent. Does X become Y? Does Y undermine X? Does the speaker expect his audience to misread X as Y? Regardless of how X and Y are related to each other, the speaker wants to show this relationship, but only subtly. After all, the parallel structure doesn’t show this relationship at all, and expects his listeners to fill in the gap.

I don’t think simply having ‘all are X, all are Y’ would make any sense, so I rewrote the verses to subtly show the relationship between X and Y. But I did preserve six of the eight ‘all’s, since they do bring a sense of force in the original Chinese. I’m worried that English won’t tolerate so many ‘all’s. I’m not entirely sure how to preserve the force of the repetitions without clogging up the verses.



Slaves in this World of Dust 尘世奴隶

Original song: 野孩子乐队 by 尘世奴隶



Three things about this song make it hard to translate.

First, the title. The word 尘世 Chen Shi (lit. dust world) originates from Buddhism and Taoism and refers to the human world. The ‘dust’ in the world may refer to the small, negligible scale of the human world, which is nothing compared to Buddha’s world. In contemporary Mandarin, most people would not spontaneously think of the Buddhist connotation of this world. When I hear ‘dust,’ I think about how tainted this world can be, how ordinary people may live a difficult life and, when they embark on a long quest (both in the physical and metaphorical sense), they tread through a dusty wind, and their hair gets coated in dust.

Northern China specifically is known to have little precipitation and regular sandstorms in the spring. Wild Children is a band that calls Northwestern China home, so it is sensible that these conditions would shape their songwriting.

Second, the meter of the music. Prior to listening to this song, I had never encountered a 7/4 meter in music. It lacks the marching-band-like quality like the 2/4 beat; it doesn’t flow like smooth red wine in the romantic 3/4 or 6/8 meter; and it doesn’t have the feeling of a stable foundation in the confident 4/4 meter.

The 7/4 meter in this song feels like an amalgamation of 3/4 and 4/4. In the intro and verse parts of the song, each bar follows a 3/4 and 4/4 pattern. I count three beats and find myself ready to dance to the music. But as I anticipate another three beats, I count an additional beat and lose the dance rhythm. And then I hear three beats again, and then four more beats. The extra beat gives me a feeling that the speaker wants to tell a story but hasn’t found the right words. I hear an elliptic shape in the music. The wobbliness comes from the extra beat the speaker insists on sneaking in

## Spring Time

Alyssa Kimura

*Mint green strolls on days of gray:  
laughter-scented icebreakers warmed  
the wintry weather  
and me up to you. Refreshing,  
calming, the color of your companionship  
is the muted green of springtime sweets,  
the kind that ponders quietly under  
pale pink sprinkles, petals of...  
potential?  
Perhaps. But under ephemeral flowers  
the matcha remains bittersweet.*

*You’re perfect as jade, shining with  
sweet humility, charisma,  
tenacity, wit—  
with every emerald spectacle,  
you cast jade lenses in rose color  
and show me everything I long to be.  
Time after time, you leave me green  
with envy-tinged admiration.*

*Time is gray:  
Every glimpse a fraction of a moment,  
Caught mid-morph, yet always running,  
slowly,  
imperceptibly,  
inevitably,  
Until we blink  
and it suddenly  
fades to  
black.*

*As long as the world turns,  
it’ll turn from green to gray and back again  
but never waits for the blush of your return.  
So in eternity I’ll preserve our green:  
to ensure the memories never die,  
in fadeless malachite I’ll dye our time.*





Mo‘o are powerful shapeshifters, often depicted as geckos, in Hawaiian mythology. *Mo‘olelo*, the Hawaiian word for “story,” is a combination of the words *mo‘o* (albeit with a different meaning in this case) and *‘ōlelo*, meaning “language.” And of course, “tail” is a homophone for “tale.” Hooray for niche bilingual puns.

*Kappa* are amphibious creatures from Japanese mythology. It is said they must keep the dish on their heads hydrated at all times. Kappa are also particularly fond of cucumber—and pickles, though suspended in salted vinegar rather than water, are essentially very hydrated cucumbers (if you ignore the science). Hence, *kappa* in a pickle jar.



Don't you know 你可知道

The hardest thing about this song to translate is actually the title. The word-by-word translation is “you-can-know-?,” in other words, “how-can-you-know.” I read the title as a rhetorical question that implies “you don’t know.” But the phrase does imply a soft accusatory voice that seems to connote a sense of, “Hey, you only see this about us. Have you ever considered the story behind us?” or “Hey, you only see what’s on the surface. How would you ever understand the backstory?” The accusation is soft because it comes from the party of less power and is directed as a bigger party that has narrative authority. Perhaps this song can be interpreted as the speaker’s pushing a Chinese metropolitan audience to reflect on their biased position when looking at Northwestern China.



你可知道

你说那山上的杜鹃花儿红  
你可知道 它长了多少年  
你问那大路上骑马呀走过的人  
趟过的河 它有多少  
你听那飞过的杜鹃鸟儿叫  
你可知道 它家在哪里  
你猜那远方背井呀离乡的人  
走过的路 它有多少

Don't you know

Azaleas on the mountains, blooming red –

Don't you know how many years it took them to grow?

People on the road, riding their horses –

Did you ever wonder how many roads they've walked down?

Hear the cuckoo gliding across the sky –

Don't you know where is the place it calls home?

Remember the people away from home –

Did you ever ask them how many rivers they've crossed?



Wild Children 野孩子 (an eponymous song as the name of the band)



Wild Children

They say, your face is covered in dust and mud  
They say, your tears are flying in the wind  
They ask you which mountain you come from  
They don't think anyone listens to your songs

Don't ask me who I am away from the mountains  
Don't ask me who I trust under the sun  
I don't hate anyone, even when I starve and shiver  
I don't wait for love, while flowers bloom and wither

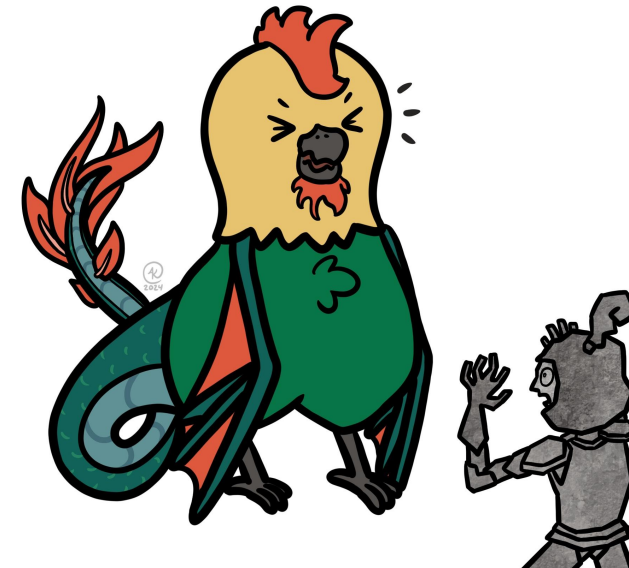
The original lyrics:

野孩子

他们说你的脸上沾满灰，  
他们说你的泪在天上飞  
他们说你的家在山野里，  
他们说你的歌有谁来听

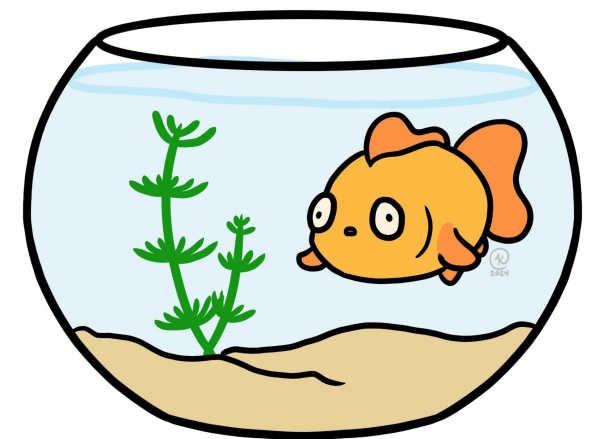
不要问山高路远我是谁  
不要管太阳下面我信谁  
不要说冷了饿了我恨谁  
不要等花开花落我爱谁

staring contest loser



Cockatrices are said to have a gaze that turns people to stone. I imagine it's pretty hard to win a staring contest when your opponent becomes a statue, though.

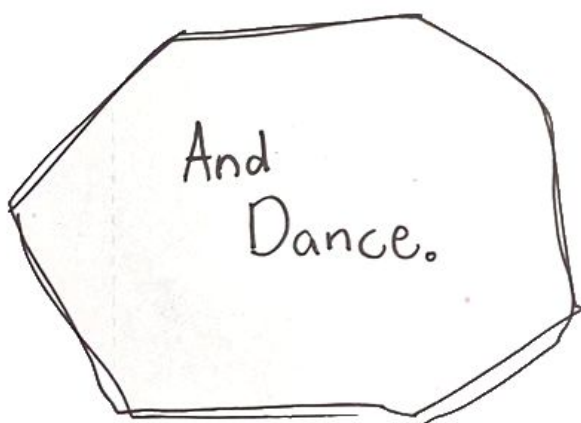
i forgot



Goldfish supposedly have a three-second memory. Although this is just a myth, I find the idea quite funny.

Alyssa Kimura





In 1996, Zhang Quan and Xiao Suo moved to Beijing and joined Beijing's nascent underground independent rock and folk music scene. They performed on stage for the first time on January 1st, 1997, with three other independent musicians (one bassist, one drummer, and one melodist). From there, Wild Children expanded its roster and established its status as one of the most important Chinese folk bands in the late 1990s and early 2000s. The band temporarily disbanded in 2003, shortly before Xiao Suo passed away from stomach cancer. A decade later, Zhang reunited with a few other former Wild Children members, recruited a couple emerging musicians, and restarted the band. Today, the band calls Dali, Yunnan, home, with Zhang being its only member who has performed for the band before 2003.

The lyrics of Wild Children's music wrestle with the theme of marginalization. Zhang Quan writes and sings about being from the poor, remote Northwest region of a communist giant and then rising global superpower – about being misunderstood, ignored, and looked down upon. In an age in which many Chinese singers aim to write songs that can generate the most clicks on social media, Wild Children's works stand out as caring for the forgotten people who have not found their place in China's stories of success. They look beyond the music industry's consumerist frenzy and remain loyal to the meaning of folk music.



*Translations from Wild Children*

*Tony Hao*

*mai*

Founded in 1995 by Zhang Quan (张佺) and Xiao Suo (小索, the artist name of Suo Wenjun 索文俊), Wild Children (野孩子) calls many Chinese cities home. The Southern city of Hangzhou witnessed the band’s original two-man foundation; Beijing saw the band’s most vibrant years as a core member of China’s underground rock/folk movement around 2000. However, regardless of the band’s physical location, Wild Children will always remain a music group of Northwestern China, a region known for its arid climate, difficult geographical landscape, and cultural influences from Buddhism, Islam, and non-Han ethnic groups. The region has a rich artistic and musical tradition distinct from that of other parts of China. One of its idiosyncratic musical forms is *Hua’er* (花儿, lit. ‘Flowers.’ Also known as *Shaonian*, 少年, lit. ‘Youth’). It descends from the agricultural tradition of singing loudly in the hilly fields and waiting for a louder response from one’s neighbors.

Wild Children perform original songs written by many members, covers of old songs, and musical adaptations of poetry. The most important songwriter of the group is its founder Zhang Quan. Born in 1968, Zhang grew up in rural Qinghai Province, where people shepherded sheep, drank hard liquor, grew wheat and potatoes, trekked over mountains, and sang *Hua’er* during any part of the day. Qinghai borders Tibet and remains one of the least populated regions in China, and singing loud songs outdoors perhaps helps people seek company and cope with solitude. The Northwestern music tradition is rooted deeply in Zhang Quan’s heart. In the early 1990s, he met with Xiao Suo and, with his new friend, hiked along China’s Yellow River and collected local music in hundreds of small villages on the Loess Plateau. Growing up listening to Northwestern music but also having explored Western music, Zhang Quan and Xiao Suo found the untrained village singers’ music both familiar and strange.

THEY SAY THE LANGUAGE OF LOVE IS RED  
EYES. THE WINDOWS OF THE SOUL  
but the language of mine is the color  
of your eyes — the ones staring dead  
right into my soul like I'm a book  
and you're a curious reader who  
only wanted to take a quick look  
into the world inside my mind  
only to discover that these eyes  
are my own — and I remind  
myself that you are a **MIRROR**  
I use to see my fragile heart as  
it beats in *colors of a lover*



## Selections from *Makura no Sōshi* “The Pillow Book”<sup>1</sup>

*Sei Shōnagon, trans. Pinyu Hwang*

### 1

春はあけぼの。やうやう白くなりゆく山ぎは、すこしあかりて、  
紫だちたる雲のほそくたなびきたる。

Spring: at daybreak. Mountain ridges brightening as they turn white little by little, purple-tinged clouds trailing [over the sky].

夏は夜。月のころはさらなり。闇もなほ。螢のおほく飛びちがひたる。また、ただ一つ二つなど、ほのかにうち光りて行くもをかし。雨など降るもをかし。

Summer: at night. Even better when the moon is out. And the darkness too. [To see] so many fireflies flitting about, or [to see] only one or two, letting loose dim flickers as they go, is charming. The falling of rain & such is also charming.

秋は夕暮。夕日のさして山の端いと近うなりたるに、鳥のねどころへ行くとて、三つ四つ、二つ三つなど飛びいそぐさへあはれなり。まいて雁などのつらねたるが、いと小さく見ゆるは、いとをかし。日入り果てて、風のおと、虫の音など、はた言ふべきにあらず。

Autumn: at dusk. The setting sun pours down, edging ever nearer to the mountain(s’ )tops, and birds make to retire to [their] beds: three or four, two or three, hurried in [their] flights—even [such a sight] is magnificent. Not to mention the wild geese, lined up and growing ever smaller—[this, too,] is very enchanting. As the sun sinks entirely, the sound of wind, the sound of insects... [these], too, cannot be put into words.

冬はつとめて。雪の降りたるは言ふべきにもあらず。霜のいと白きも、またさらでもいと寒きに、火などいそぎおこして、炭持てわたるも、いとききづきし。昼になりて、ぬるくゆるびもていけば、火桶の火も、白き灰がちになりてわろし。

Winter: early morning. Neither can the falling of snow be put into words. [With] the white of frost, or even without, in the cold, making fire in haste, bringing around the charcoal—[these] too are such becoming [sights]. By the time noon comes about, when [the cold] gradually subsides in turn, the flames in the brazier too have turned to whitened ashes—unseemly [as it may be].

—6—

<sup>1</sup> [A version of the following translations and notes](#) was first published in Issue 112 of *Cordite Poetry Review*.

### The Red Beret

*Tomas Cordero*

#### I

I start with whites: a sheet, a cotton spread,  
my button-downs, his pillowcase, the like.  
Our life, in short: a copy-paper bed,  
a week in monochrome. If I could spike  
our boredom with a little bit of red,  
bring down a bold but necessary strike,  
we wouldn’t have to posture anymore.  
I eye the hanging colors—*this is war*.

#### II

“It can’t be helped!” I yell as I walk in.  
“A red beret got thrown in with my whites  
somehow.” I grin, and all the faces grin,  
then turn back to their laptops. Out of sight,  
their image of a man whose wife (a thin  
and pretty-mannered girl, they’re sure, alight  
with folly) mixed her own and husband’s wash  
escapes their minds. And I escape the lash.

#### III

A life is in my hands; I draw my arm.  
The pin is pulled, the lid is open wide—  
but somewhere, barely there, the old alarm  
awakens me and pulls my head aside.  
“Is not the way of saints to do no harm?”  
I take a breath; I think, I can’t decide.  
There is no blast, no great parade of fire.  
I hang the red beret back on the wire.







## A Poem of Purple

I remember that butterfly that landed on your shoulders  
Of wings purple, deep and almost hypnotizing, unlike no other  
The purple flaps in a beat ... a beat ... a beat ...  
It makes me think of you — of when we will next meet  
Your back is turned to me and I hear the whistle of a train  
Don't say goodbye for I'll seek you in the next purple rain

mai

8

正月一日、三月三日は、いとうららかなる。五月五日は、曇りくらしたる。七月七日は、曇りくらして、夕方は晴れたる空に、月いと明かく、星の数も見えたる。

The first day of the first month & the third day of the third month when they're such fine [ones].  
The fifth day of the fifth month when it's entirely cloudy. The seventh day of the seventh month when, cloudy all day, [in] the evening, in the cleared-up sky, the moon's very bright, and the stars countable.

九月九日は、暁がたより雨すこし降りて、菊の露もこちたく、おほひたる綿などもいたく濡れ、うつしの香ももてはやされて、つとめてはやみにたれど、なほ曇りて、ややもせば降ちぬべく見えたるものをかし。

The ninth day of the ninth month, when rain has been lightly falling(, falling) since daybreak; the dewdrops on the chrysanthemums are extravagant, even the cotton covering [the flowers] has been drenched, and the lingering fragrance, too, becomes further pronounced; [the rain] stops in the early morning, but it's yet cloudy, as though it would come down [again at any moment]—[this], too, is enchanting.

—6—

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心ときめきするもの 雀の子飼。ちご遊ばする所の前わたる。よき薫物たきて一人臥したる。唐鏡のすこし暗き、見たる。よき男の、車とどめて、案内し問はせたる。頭洗ひ化粧じて、香ばしうしみたる衣など着たる。ことに見る人なき所にても、心のうちは、なほいとをかし。待つ人などのある夜、雨の音、風の吹きゆるがすも、ふとおどろかる。

Things that make the heart flutter: Feeding sparrow chicks. Passing by a place where children have been permitted to play. Burning fine incense & lying down alone. Looking—into the slight dull of a Chinese mirror. A fine gentleman parking his cart (before the house), having [an attendant] ask for reception and make an inquiry. Having washed [my] head (hair) and dabbed on cosmetics, dressed up in clothes that have been soaked in fragrant scents. Even if it is a place where there's no one to see in particular, [from] within the heart it's all the more enchanting. On nights when there is someone to wait for, the sound of rain and even the swinging gusts of wind, too, become unexpectedly startling.

—6—



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過ぎにし方恋しきもの 枯れたる葵。雛遊びの調度。二藍、葡萄染めなどのさいでの押しへされて、草子の中などにありける、見つけたる。また、をりからあはれなりし人の文、雨など降りつれづれなる日、さがし出でたる。去年の蝙蝠。

Things nostalgic of a time passed: Wilted hollyhocks. Accessories for doll play.<sup>2</sup> Discovering scraps of cloth in hues of indigo & lilac & such [colors], pressed in a bound book. Or, on a rainy, tedious day, stumbling upon a letter that struck keenly [because it had been] from someone met at just the right time. Last year's bat (fan).<sup>3</sup>

—s—

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冬は、いみじう寒き。夏は、世に知らず暑き。

Winter, [best] that it be terribly cold. Summer, that the heat be unprecedented.

—s—

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五月四日の夕つ方、青き草おほく、いとうるはしく切りて、左右になひて、赤衣着たる男の行くこそ、をかしけれ。

On the evening of the fourth day of the fifth month, having neatly cut an abundance of blue-green grass and [now] carrying it on his left and right [shoulders], a man dressed in red and trekking past [makes for a] charming [sight].<sup>4</sup>

—s—

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ただ過ぎに過ぐるもの 帆かけたる舟。人の齡。春、夏、秋、冬。

Things that simply pass by: A boat with its sail set. A person's age. Spring / summer / autumn / winter.

—s—

<sup>2</sup> 雛祭り *Hinamatsuri* is also known as the Doll Festival and is a holiday celebrating female children. It takes place annually on March 3.

<sup>3</sup> 蝙蝠扇 *kawahori ougi* “bat fan.” So named because of a resemblance to the wings of a bat when spread open.

Yellow Yellow Yellow  
Yellow Yellow Black  
Yellow Yellow Yellow  
Yellow Yellow Black  
Find me something to fill in the black





Kyle Lin's **EleMeNtal**  
an original online card game



Scan to Play!



Tutorial

## Notes

Punctuation has meaning. In contemporary written English, it is the commas and periods, the dashes and hyphens, the colons, semicolons, that frame the context and the scope of words and phrases. Different types of pauses are denoted by different punctuation marks. Sentences and phrases may be grouped by quotes and parentheses. A period by convention marks the end of a thought, an independent clause, but it can also mark the pauses between individual words, when, for example: Uttered. With. Gritted. Teeth. Commas tend to denote the pause connecting an independent clause with a dependent clause or phrase, though a pair of commas may also often delimit the bounds of an appositive or a relative clause. Ellipses (...) can be used to mean “and so on” or to connote speechlessness and the act of trailing off (while in contrast the *comma ellipsis* (,,), a product most likely of the internet, is more casual and liable to a comedic interpretation, and can never mean “and so on”). Em dashes are versatile things in English; they’re often used when a period is too strong and a comma feels too weak, and, depending on the context, they can also function like parentheses or colons, not to mention being used to mark interruption in dialogue. Punctuation is moreover idiosyncratic, subjective, in the sense that each of us may attribute slightly different meanings to the silence denoted by a particular punctuation mark—undoubtedly, we all have our preferences.

Sei Shōnagon’s *Makura no Sōshi* 枕草子 “The Pillow Book” was completed in 1002, written in *bungo* (classical Japanese), and belongs to the genre of *zuihitsu*, referring to collections of personal essays and fragments of ideas that tend to be in response to the writer’s surroundings. The nature of *zuihitsu* resembles that of a personal journal, a notebook, a scrapbook of writings: it is casual in tone, thoughts are abbreviated, their completion left to the reader to infer, and purely functional words (e.g. forms of the copula) are often omitted. Moreover, *Makura no Sōshi* was written in a time prior to the invention of modern punctuation—the original manuscript contained neither (the Japanese equivalents of) commas nor periods.

In the translations presented here, I am interested particularly in how punctuation can be used to translate into English relationships between words and phrases that, in classical Japanese (but not in contemporary English), can be represented morphemically and phonemically (i.e. by actual sounds) or by having an understanding of the relevant cultural context and rules of elliptical constructions in Japanese. For example, there is no single English equivalent for the Japanese topic marker は *wa*, and unlike English, Japanese does not require all finite or independent clauses to have an overt subject. Such linguistic differences mean that, often, specific relationships between words and meanings expressed by the Japanese text cannot be captured in a straightforward way using a combination of English words and morphemes. In my translations, I explore the possibility of expressing these connections through punctuation.<sup>5</sup>

<sup>4</sup> The cut grass (presumably long stalks) mentioned in the passage are likely in preparation for the ritual banquet held on the fifth day of every fifth month (known as 端午の節句 *tango no sekku*).

<sup>5</sup> The reader should keep in mind that the punctuation in the Japanese source text provided here did not exist in Sei Shōnagon’s manuscript and were only later added by scholars. This also means that different editions of the source text may be differently punctuated. The edition referenced here is 新編日本古典文学全集8 *Shinpen Nihon Koten Bungaku Zenshū 18* (JapanKnowledge), annotated by 松尾聰 Matsuo Satoshi and 永井和子 Nagai Kazuko. The act of adding punctuation itself is an act of interpretation and analysis—a partial translation, if you will.



model: Shelley Mora (@shelleeeymora)  
hair/makeup: Aeri Golden-Thompson (@aerlili)  
photographer: J. Charles Stephens (@ofisyarurun)



Shrimp Colors (They say shrimps see colors we'll never see)

Ayaka Kondo

On nights like this, when I can see shrimp colors,  
I imagine the iridescence of the eyeshadow you put on to go clubbing  
I imagine you're drowning your familiar scent  
in sweet perfume, I imagine you're  
irreversible and I let myself look down on you

I wish you could see the way I saw you  
A hundred thousand strokes of a hundred thousand colors  
Sparks flickering. Too bright, too painful, too everything.

I remind myself of the disappointment  
of when you called me silly  
Of flower crowns discarded, vacant playgrounds and unspoken confessions  
And when I think of you I think of strobe lights, of places I don't frequent, of you contorted into man-made positions  
I paint over you, thousand strokes in crayola hues

エビ色 (エビは人にみえない色も見えるという)

近藤彩夏

エビの色が見える夜は  
艶やかなアイメイクでクラブに行くあなたを想像する  
その懐かしい匂いを殺して  
甘い香水であなたは  
変わったと想像する。わたしはそうやって、あなたを見下すの。

めで  
あなたがわたしの愛みえていたらよかったのに  
百万本の線で描かれた、百万色の  
弾ける火の粉。眩しすぎて、辛すぎて、全て。

わたしは繰り返す、あの時の絶望  
わたしをおかしいといったあなた  
置き去りの花冠と、誰もいない公園、口にできなかった告白  
そしてあなたを思う時、思うのはストロボライトの下、わたしの行かない何処かで 誰かに踊らされている姿  
そうやってあなたを塗りつぶすの、わかりやすい色に



model: Shelley Mora (@shelleeeymora)  
hair/makeup: Aeri Golden-Thompson (@aerlili)  
photographer: Ayaka Kondo (@flowertropes)

